Jordan Lee

Senior Backend Engineer

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 8 years of experience building high-throughput payment and ledger systems in Go and Python. Led the redesign of Northwind Pay's ledger to 4x throughput at 99.99% availability. Author of open-source infrastructure tools with 800+ GitHub stars and merged contributions to httpx and the Prometheus Python client.

EXPERIENCE

Northwind Pay — Austin, TX

Senior Software Engineer, Payments Platform — Apr 2023 – Present

- Led the redesign of the double-entry ledger service in Go and PostgreSQL, raising peak throughput 4x to 6,000 transfers/sec while holding 99.99% availability through Black Friday traffic.
- Introduced a transactional outbox on Kafka for payment events, eliminating dual-write inconsistencies that caused ~30 reconciliation tickets per month.
- Cut p99 API latency from 180 ms to 45 ms with Redis caching for balance reads and covering indexes on the hottest PostgreSQL queries.
- Mentor 4 engineers and run the backend design-review guild; authored the RFC process now used by 6 teams.

Software Engineer — Feb 2021 – Mar 2023

- Built the idempotent transfers API (gRPC and REST) that now processes $1.2B in annual payment volume.
- Migrated 40+ services to Kubernetes on AWS EKS with Helm and Terraform, reducing infrastructure cost by 28%.
- Rolled out CI/CD on GitHub Actions with per-PR preview environments, cutting median review time from 2 days to 4 hours.

Software Engineer — Jun 2018 – Jan 2021
Brightline Analytics — *Remote*

- Developed Python (FastAPI, Celery) ingestion services processing 50M events/day for 300+ enterprise customers.
- Designed the public API's rate limiting, later open-sourced as fastapi-ratelimit (268 GitHub stars).
- Reduced on-call pages by 60% by adding OpenTelemetry tracing and SLO-based alerting in Grafana.

PROJECTS

Ledgerline | github.com/jordanlee-example/ledgerline — Feb 2024 – Present
Go, PostgreSQL, gRPC, Kafka

- Open-source double-entry ledger with idempotent transfers and event sourcing; 412 GitHub stars and 37 forks.
- Sustains 4,800 transfers/sec at p99 under 35 ms on a single 4-vCPU node in published benchmarks.

fastapi-ratelimit | github.com/jordanlee-example/fastapi-ratelimit — May 2023 – Present
Python, FastAPI, Redis, pytest

- Async rate-limiting middleware (sliding window and token bucket) published on PyPI; under 0.4 ms overhead per request at 20k req/s, 96% test coverage.

k8s-preview-envs | github.com/jordanlee-example/k8s-preview-envs — Sep 2024 – Present
Terraform, Helm, GitHub Actions, Go

- Ephemeral preview environment per pull request on EKS or GKE, with a Go controller that garbage-collects stale namespaces; 95 GitHub stars.

OPEN SOURCE CONTRIBUTIONS

encode/httpx | github.com/encode/httpx — Apr 2024 – Nov 2025
Contributor

- 3 merged PRs to the 13.9k-star Python HTTP client, including a fix for a connection-pool leak on cancelled requests.

prometheus/client_python | github.com/prometheus/client_python — Feb 2025 – Jun 2025
Contributor

- Added exemplar support in multiprocess mode (merged), used by services exporting traces alongside metrics.

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at Austin Aug 2014 – May 2018
B.S. in Computer Science *Austin, TX*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, SQL, Bash
Backend: gRPC, REST APIs, FastAPI, Kafka, Redis, PostgreSQL, Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture
Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EKS, RDS, S3), Kubernetes, Helm, Terraform, Docker, CI/CD, GitHub Actions
Observability: OpenTelemetry, Prometheus, Grafana, SLOs

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate — Amazon Web Services Sep 2022